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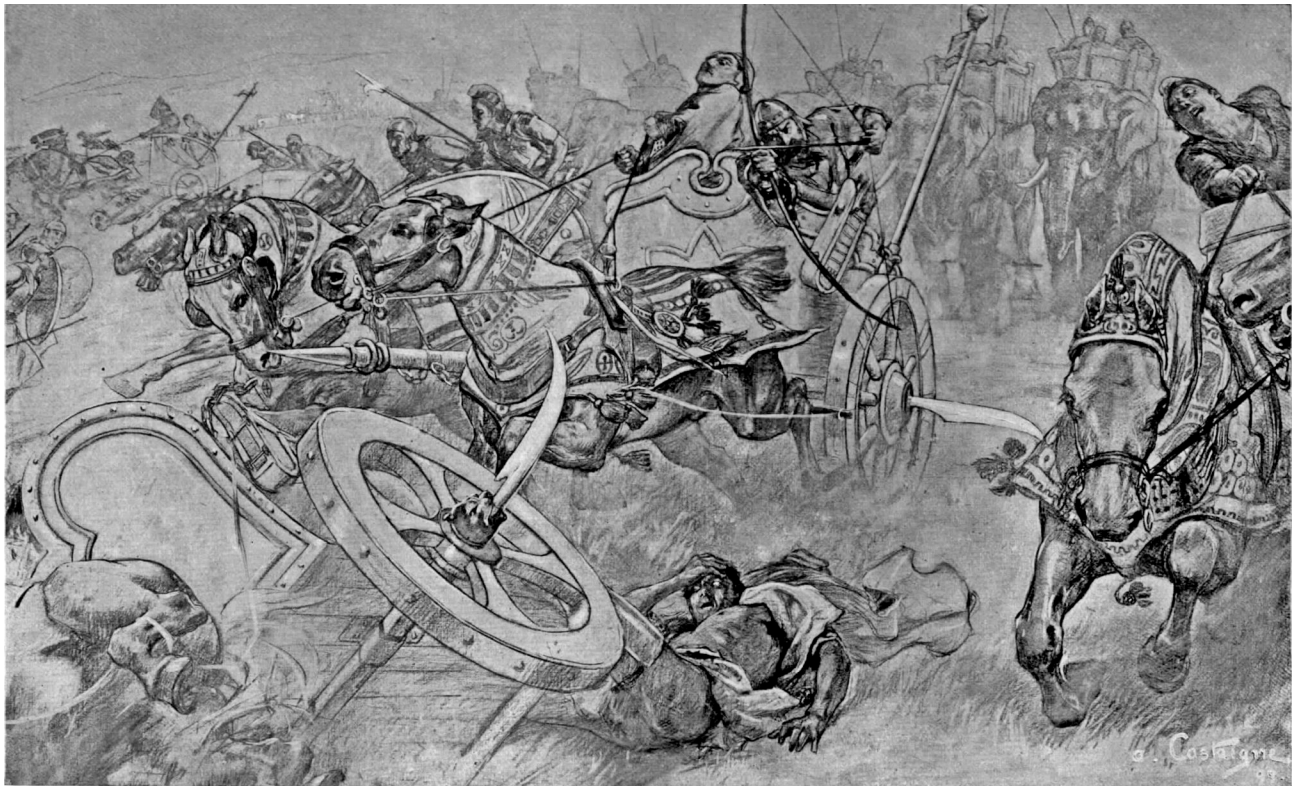
Scythe (chariot weapon)

2.15.1 Scythe (chariot weapon)

Reference:

Greek δρεπανηφόρος (drepanēforos) 2MA 13:2

Description and usage:



Scythe chariots with blades mounted on the axle of the wheels (André Castaigne (Public domain), Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons)The scythe was a sharp, curved blade that was attached to either side of a war chariot. It prevented enemy soldiers from running alongside the chariot to attack. It also could act as an offensive weapon; as the chariot drove swiftly through the enemy, the blade would cut at their legs.

Translation:

In very few languages will the idea of a weapon attached to a chariot wheel be clear. So a literal translation such as “chariots armed with scythes” (NRSV) at the end of 2MA 13:2 will probably not communicate sufficient information to the reader. GNT expands this to “chariots with sharp blades attached to their wheels.”